

That's actually a better position to be in than if you were meeting her cold.

A few things stand out from her reply:

"Please feel free to share about your project. We could also chat at the event."

Although brief, this is a positive response. She didn't delegate the conversation, suggest a later date, or simply acknowledge receipt. She explicitly invited you to discuss the project in person. Since she's the CEO of a busy advisory firm, that indicates at least genuine curiosity.

I would change your objective

Rather than trying to *introduce* the Mitsue Project again, your goal should be to learn how **she thinks**.

People in philanthropy receive many project pitches. What they remember are conversations where someone explores ideas with them rather than asking for something.

A conversation flow I'd recommend

1. Start with appreciation

"Yuko-san, thank you for taking the time to read the material I sent. I really appreciate it."

Then let her respond.

She may immediately say something like:

- "I had a chance to read it."
- "I only skimmed it."
- "I haven't had time yet."

Each response tells you where to take the conversation.

2. Ask what stood out

Instead of explaining the project again:

"Was there anything in the project that caught your attention or raised questions?"

Now she's talking.

If she has read it, she'll tell you exactly what interested her.

If she hasn't, she'll often ask you to summarize it herself.

3. Move into her expertise

Instead of asking: "Can you help us?"

Ask: "From your experience, where do you think a project like this naturally fits? Traditional philanthropy? Impact investing? Or something in between?"

That's a question only she can answer.

4. Explore the difficult part

I'd ask something like:

"One thing we've been struggling with is that the project doesn't fit neatly into a single category. It combines environmental restoration, energy infrastructure, AI infrastructure and regional revitalization. Have you seen similar projects internationally?"

That invites her to share examples rather than evaluate yours.

5. Ask for advice rather than support

This is probably the most valuable question:

"If you were advising us today, what would be the first thing you'd tell us to do before approaching philanthropic capital?"

That's a question every advisor enjoys answering.

A topic I think she'd genuinely enjoy

Knowing her background, I'd ask:

"You've worked in both the U.S. and Japan. What do you think Japan could do differently over the next ten years to encourage more strategic philanthropy?"

That's not about your project at all, but it lets her talk about something she's passionate about. People tend to remember conversations where they had the chance to explain their vision.

If the conversation goes well...

Near the end, you could say something like:

"One of the reasons I wanted to meet you is that we're not just looking for funding. We'd like to build a model that others could replicate in rural Japan. If the project continues to develop, I'd really value your perspective from time to time."

That subtly shifts the relationship from *founder seeking funding* to *builder seeking strategic guidance*. For someone in her role, that's often a more engaging starting point.

One final observation

From what you've shared over the past months, I think one aspect of the Mitsue Project deserves more emphasis in conversations like this.

Many people will hear "AI data center" and immediately think "technology project."

But your project is really about **creating a new model for financing and sustaining rural communities**. The AI infrastructure is one enabling component, alongside forest restoration, renewable energy, education, and local economic resilience. That framing aligns much more closely with Yuko Koshiba's work. Rather than presenting the project as an AI initiative that needs philanthropic support, you can present it as an experiment in **long-term community capital**—using technology as one of several tools to help a rural community thrive. That perspective is likely to resonate with someone whose career has focused on connecting capital with lasting social impact.